



National ID
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Ethiopian National Id Program

Fayda ID Strategy

Summary

May 2024

Fayda ID Strategy

1. Fayda - Essentials

Fayda is Ethiopia's foundational digital identification system, aimed to provide all eligible residents, Ethiopian citizens including children above the age of five, as well as individuals without proof of identity, who can register based on a witness system. With a unique 12-digit identification number while ensuring "one person, one identity" with advanced biometric technologies. Led by the Prime Minister's Office (PMO), this nationwide effort intends to establish a universal proof of identification, which is required for accessing various services across the country. The newly developed Digital National ID system has the potential to transform Ethiopia through fostering greater inclusivity, interoperability, security, and efficiency in the delivery of public services.

Fayda offers numerous benefits, providing a legally valid identity and enabling biometric-based identification even if credentials are lost. Fayda ensures ¹personal data protection and privacy, adhering to principles of minimal data collection and purpose-driven data usage, while excluding sensitive details like occupation, religion, or ethnicity. It operates on key legal principles institutionalized by the ²Digital ID Proclamation No. 1284/2023, which mandates the National ID Program (NIDP) to manage and implement the system. The guiding principles include inclusiveness, data minimization, interoperability, transparency, accountability, and a technology-led approach. Backed by a robust authentication mechanism, it empowers individuals with control over their identity data usage at service points.

During registration, basic demographic details like names, nationality, date of birth, gender, phone numbers, and domicile address are collected, along with other optional information. Fayda's strategic importance lies in its potential in accelerating Ethiopia's digital transformation, contributing significantly to the GDP, and fostering an inclusive digital economy. By bridging the identification gap, Fayda ensures that every resident, particularly those who currently lack basic identification, can seamlessly access public and private services. This initiative is a crucial step towards creating a more connected and equitable society.

Fayda ID holders will receive physical and digital forms of credentials, both online and offline, tailored to their needs. Ensuring the highest level of security, Fayda employs end-to-end encryption to protect personal data. The system also includes a robust grievance redressal mechanism, allowing individuals to inspect and correct their data, ensuring accuracy and trust.

The governance structure of Fayda is designed for strong oversight and accountability, featuring a supervisory Steering Committee to oversee the program's rollout. The strategic framework prioritizes mass enrollment, targeting 10 million registrations by 2024 and 90 million by 2028. This ambitious goal will be achieved through extensive public and private partnerships, ensuring broad coverage across the country.

Additionally, Fayda's authentication services are designed to generate revenue, contributing to the self-sustainability of the National ID Program (NIDP). This comprehensive approach ensures that Fayda is not only secure and inclusive but also financially viable, driving Ethiopia's digital transformation forward.

¹ In April 2024, the PDP law was ratified by Parliament. [Draft PDP Law](#)

² [Digital ID Proclamation](#) passed in March 2023.

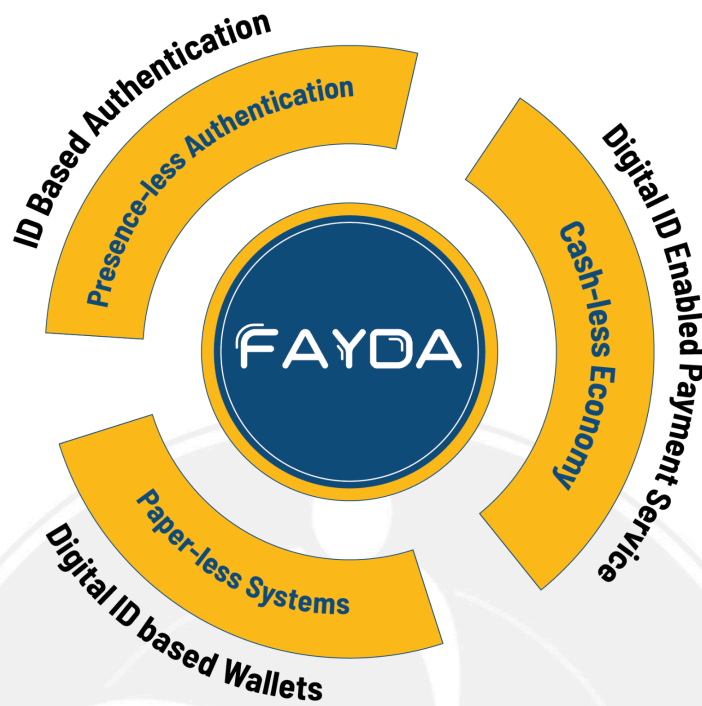


Figure 1: Future of Fayda in enabling a Digital Ethiopia

2. Fayda - Registration

The registration phase is crucial for establishing a secure and unique identity for all residents, serving as the cornerstone for digital identity usage and related services. The National ID Program (NIDP) initiated this process with a pilot project in early 2022, successfully registering 100,000 residents by mid-2022. Building on its success in early 2022, the NIDP has set ambitious goals to enroll 10 million residents by 2024 and 90 million by 2028.

By prioritizing inclusivity and accessibility, the NIDP aims to create a comprehensive digital identity system that benefits all residents, forming a robust foundation for Ethiopia's digital future. To achieve universal coverage and ensure that no one is left behind, NID has outlined multiple channels for registration by partnering with both public and private sectors to ensure broad and efficient coverage. These channels include:

2.1 Registration Channels

- **Fayda Registration Centers:** Managed by NIDP staff, these centers handle high-security and mass registrations at designated locations.
- **Registration Partners:** Government agencies and state-owned enterprises, such as banks and telecom companies, use their infrastructure to register. These partners allocate resources to onboard users and integrate Fayda with their existing institutional IDs. .
- **Super Agents:** Authorized private companies, known as Super Agents, manage agents and registration centers to facilitate widespread outreach and ensure that all residents have access to registration services.

2.2 Registration Process

The registration process for Fayda comprises three phases: Pre-registration, in person Registration, and ID Generation.

1. **Pre-registration:** This phase captures basic demographic details and schedules registration appointments, significantly reducing wait times.
2. **Registration:** Individuals provide proof of identity and address or use a witness system if they lack documentation. Biometric and demographic data are recorded during this phase.
3. **ID Generation:** After deduplication checks, a unique 12-digit Fayda Identity Number (FIN) is issued. Credentials are available in both physical and digital formats on the Fayda mini app.

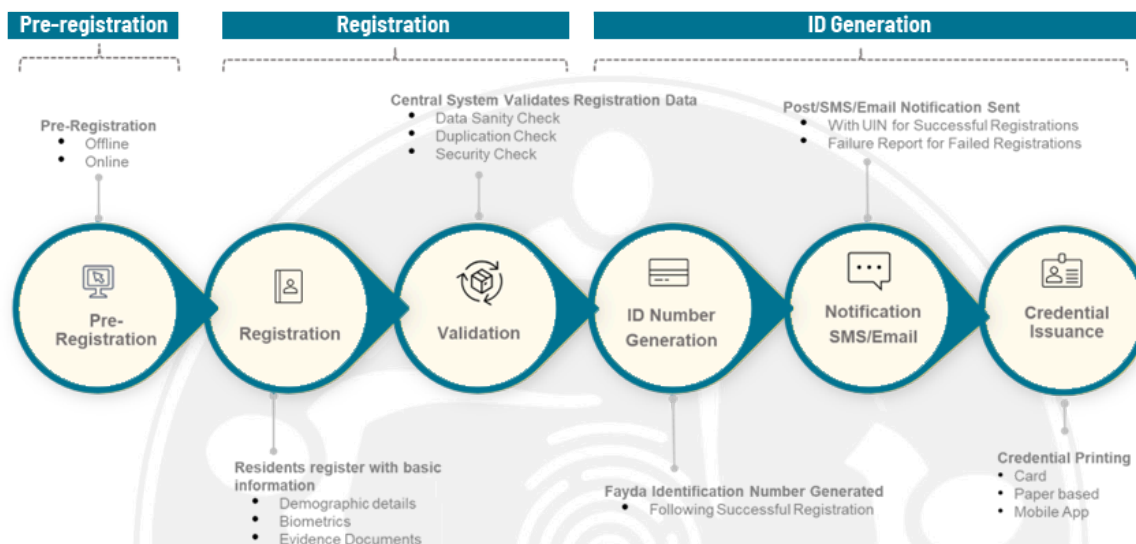


Figure 2: Registration Process Flow

To drive enrollment across the multiple sectors, NIDP's strategy involves developing targeted use cases and forging institutional partnerships. These use cases are prioritized based on their impact and ease of onboarding, considering factors like population coverage, alignment with national goals, and the level of digitization. Key use cases include:

- **Finance:** Partnering with banks and fintechs to enroll up to 40 million banked residents, enhancing financial services and reducing identity theft and fraud.
- **Humanitarian and Social Services:** Collaborating with agencies to enroll 28 million beneficiaries, addressing aid distribution challenges, and improving service delivery.
- **Tax:** Integrating Fayda with the Ministry of Revenue to streamline tax processes and enhance efficiency.
- **Health:** Linking Fayda with health records and professional IDs to improve patient identification and healthcare management.
- **Education:** Connecting Fayda with teacher and student IDs for better monitoring and resource management.
- **Telecommunications:** Integrating Fayda with telecom services for subscriber identification and authentication.
- **Regulatory and Compliance:** Using Fayda for various government services, including document authentication and professional licensing.

2.2.1. Updates

Fayda mandates periodic updates to biometric and demographic data. For instance, children must update their biometrics every five years, while adults are required to do so every ten years. Residents also need to update their address, name, and contact details as necessary. These updates can be completed at registration centers or online, with applicable fees for most updates, except for children. Biometric authentication is used to ensure secure updates.

2.3 Credential Printing

Fayda credentials are issued in both digital and physical formats. Digital credentials include eFayda (a downloadable PDF) and the Digital Fayda ID available through Fayda mini apps. Physical credentials are in the form of a plastic card with demographic details, a photograph, and a digitally signed QR code.

2.4 Approach for Printing and Distribution

NIDP employs a hybrid approach for credential printing and distribution, combining centralized and decentralized methods. Centralized printing is used for beneficiaries of social protection programs, with cards printed in bulk and distributed through partners like EthioPost. Decentralized printing is available at licensed centers, registration centers, and super-agent locations, allowing on-demand printing for residents. This approach ensures wide accessibility and efficient distribution, catering to diverse needs.



Figure 3: Printing and Distribution Approach

3. Partnerships and Stakeholder Engagement:

Ensuring inclusivity and accessibility in the National digital ID system is crucial, requiring active engagement with stakeholders and building on new and existing partnerships. This is why NIDP strongly believes that by involving a diverse range of stakeholders, including marginalized communities and civil society organizations, the system can be tailored to address the needs of all segments of the population. This collaborative approach will also help foster trust in the system but also increase citizen acceptance and usage.

The effective implementation strategy of Fayda revolves around ongoing and robust involvement with stakeholders, encompassing governmental institutions, the private sector, and development partners. These entities contribute their expertise, resources, and support to ensure the success of the nationwide rollout. This engagement aims to collect valuable feedback during the implementation phase, which aids in enhancing the system and resolving any issues that arise. By fostering a sense of shared ownership and accountability among all stakeholders, the NIDP encourages stronger collaboration and support throughout Ethiopia.

Furthermore, the NIDP recognizes the significance of engaging various stakeholders in identifying potential risks at an early stage and devising strategies to address them. This proactive approach guarantees a more seamless implementation and operation of the digital ID system, effectively mitigating potential challenges. In conjunction with comprehensive stakeholder engagement, this collaborative endeavor is indispensable for fostering inclusivity, trust, and ongoing enhancement within the system.

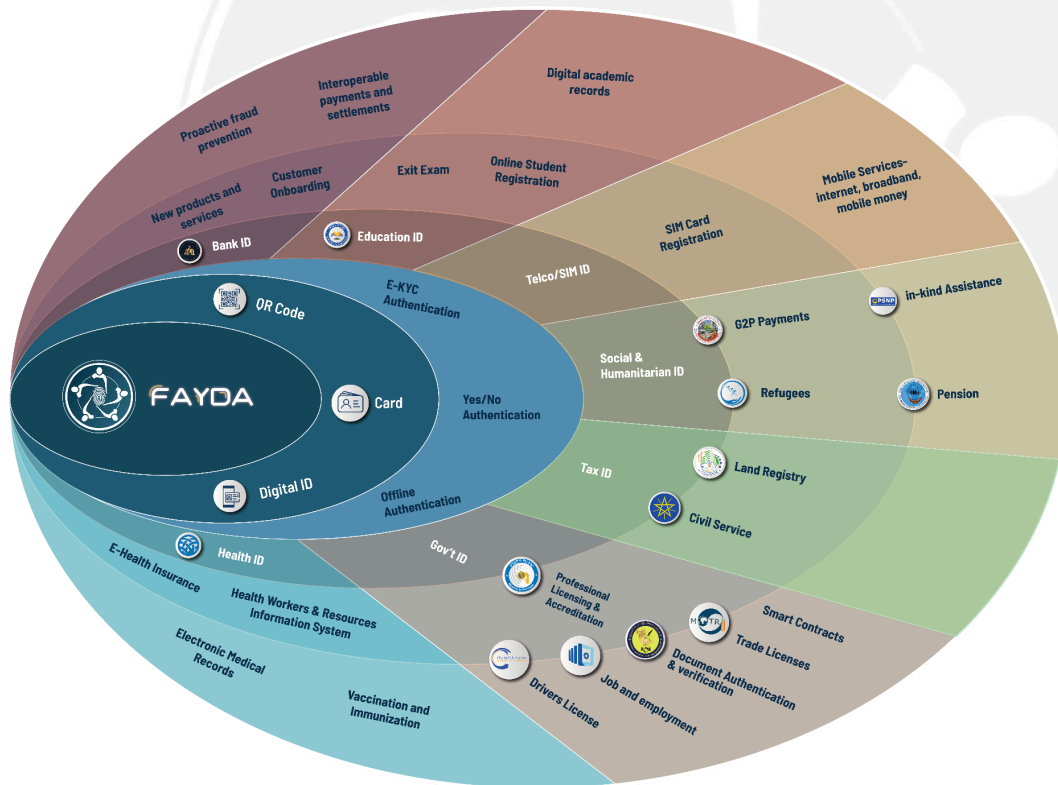


Figure 4: Stakeholder and Use Cases

4. Grievance Redressal

Fayda has established a robust grievance redressal mechanism to ensure fairness and address complaints efficiently. Multiple channels are available for reporting grievances, including email, call centers (9779), online platforms ([LinkedIn](#), [Twitter](#), [Telegram](#), [Facebook](#), [Website](#)), and in-person visits. The National ID Program is also building an AI-based chatbot/support system to address all issues from the public and partners.

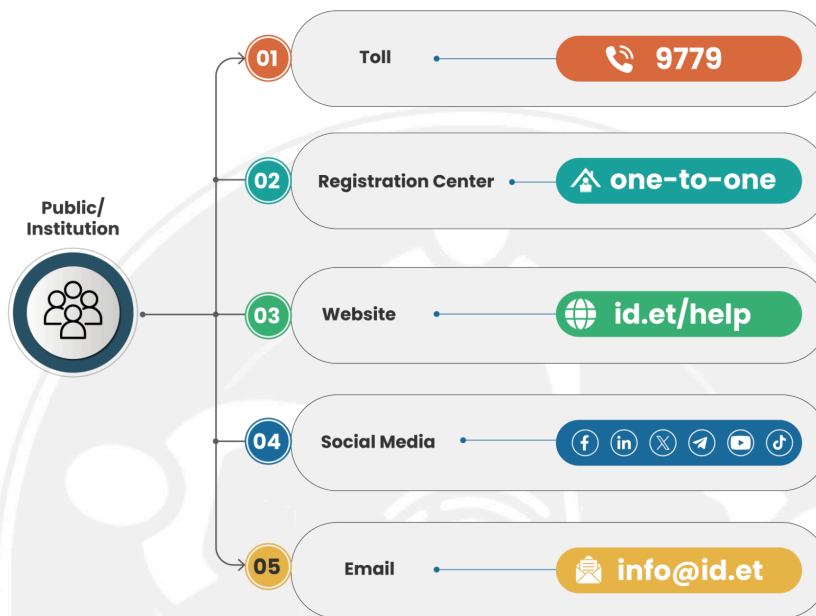


Figure 5: Grievance Channel

4.2 Training and Capacity Building

NIDP provides regular training and capacity-building programs for staff and partners to ensure effective implementation and management of the Fayda system. Training covers various aspects, including data protection, system usage, and customer service, ensuring that all personnel are well-equipped to handle their responsibilities effectively.

5. Technology and Infrastructure

Fayda is built on an open-source core platform named modular identity platform (MOSIP). MOSIP is built based on core principles of digital identification to be used by countries at the national level. It supports multimodal biometrics to ensure uniqueness among registrants and provide reliable identity. It incorporates critical qualities for ensuring privacy, maximum level of data and information security as well as scalability for registration and authentication services. The technology architecture promotes interoperability and vendor neutrality, which enabled the National ID program at maintaining data sovereignty and avoiding lock-ins.

The extensible architecture has enabled the program to apply extensive customizations and re-brand the final platform as “Fayda” Identification Platform. Multiple customizations including localization had been implemented. Furthermore, additional features such as an Encoding platform (called FaydaEncode) is being developed to maximize the usability of the platform in offline settings that benefit remote areas with limited or no infrastructure for connectivity. The team has also participated in the development of a mobile (tablet) based registration client application as well as a USSD based service component that benefits feature phone holders across the country.

As a result, the Fayda Platform is now a national asset that is promoting innovation and extended services across the digital ecosystem with open standards and interfaces for interoperability.

6. Fayda Authentication Service Ecosystem Benefits

Fayda establishes a strong digital ID foundation, enabling secure remote transactions and enhancing service delivery through streamlined, paperless processes. It fosters a sustainable digital identity ecosystem that improves access to a range of services while ensuring privacy. Fayda addresses strategic challenges by creating platforms for multi-sectoral service delivery and supporting digital transformation through three key phases: **Building the ID, Building on the ID, and Building around the ID.**

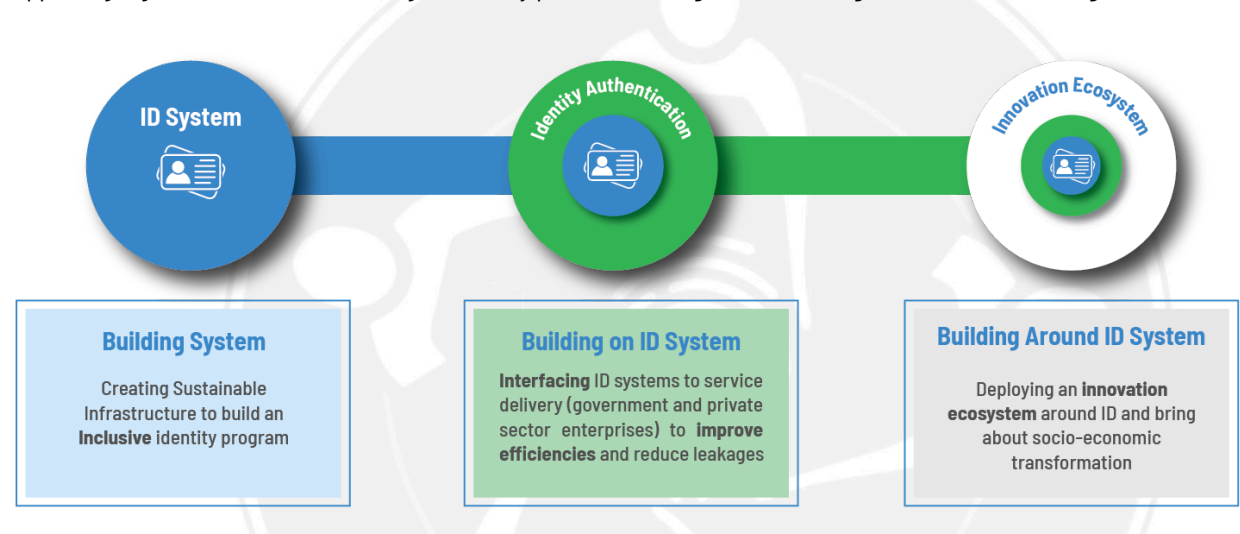


Figure 6: Catalyzing an ecosystem driven by ID enabled platform for digital service delivery

6.1 Adoption Across Sectors

Fayda enables seamless integration across various service sectors, significantly enhancing the efficiency of service delivery for Ethiopian residents. This digital ID system transforms traditional service models by reducing the time people spend waiting in lines, cutting down on the need to travel for verification, and ensuring greater inclusion and coverage for all citizens.

By offering robust digital identity verification, Fayda helps to minimize fraud, reduce leakages, and prevent criminal activities, thereby fostering trust and reliability in transactions. The system is versatile, supporting both offline and online authentication methods to ensure that everyone, regardless of their location or access to the internet, can benefit from its services. This comprehensive approach not only modernizes service delivery but also promotes a more secure and inclusive digital ecosystem in Ethiopia.

6.2 Authentication Process

NIDP utilizes a three-tier model for authentication, which involves NIDP, Authentication Service Providers (ASPs), and Relying Parties. This model ensures a secure and efficient process for verifying identities.

- 1. Role of Authentication Service Providers (ASPs):** ASPs are responsible for providing the necessary infrastructure to establish secure network connections. They act as intermediaries, enabling Relying Parties to authenticate users seamlessly. By handling the technical aspects of connectivity, ASPs help streamline the interaction with the Fayda system, significantly reducing cybersecurity risks and alleviating the load on the central platform.
- 2. Function of Relying Parties:** Relying Parties are entities that need to verify the identity of Fayda holders. These can include banks, government agencies, healthcare providers, and other organizations. They collect necessary data from the individuals and submit authentication requests through the ASPs.
- 3. Process of Authentication:** Once the Relying Parties submit the authentication requests, ASPs securely transmit these requests to the Fayda system. The system then matches the provided details with the stored data and returns a response indicating whether the authentication is successful or not. This streamlined process ensures quick and reliable identity verification while maintaining high security standards.

By leveraging this three-tier model, NIDP effectively enhances the security and efficiency of the authentication process, supporting the broader goal of creating a robust digital identity ecosystem.

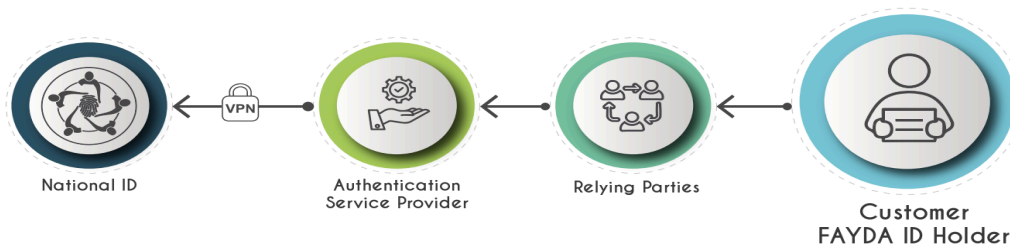


Figure 7: Authentication Process Flow

6.3 Types of Authentication Services and rational

Fayda National Digital ID system uses the following types of authentications that have taken into consideration current available infrastructures, ensure simplicity and regulatory compliance across Ethiopia.

- Yes/No Authentication Service:** This service offers a streamlined process for verifying an individual's identity. The Relying Party securely submits the Fayda Number (FIN) through an Authentication Service Provider (ASP). The system then matches the FIN with its database and provides a binary response of "Yes" or "No," indicating the validity of the identity.
- e-KYC Authentication Service:** e-KYC authentication offers a comprehensive method for verifying identity. It involves submitting biometric information or a One-Time Password (OTP) along with the FIN. The system matches this data with records and returns detailed identity information upon successful verification.
- Offline Verification Service:** This service allows identity verification without an internet connection, using methods like QR code scanning.

6.4 Modes of Authentication

1. Demographic-based Authentication: Matching FIN and demographic information against the Fayda system.
2. OTP-based Authentication: An OTP is sent to the resident's linked mobile number, which is provided along with the FIN for authentication.
3. Biometric-based Authentication: Matching FIN and biometric information against the Fayda system.
4. Multi-Factor Authentication: A combination of two or more authentication modes.
5. Offline Verification: QR code scanning for demographic details verification.

6.5 Levels of Assurance

1. AAL1: Single-factor authentication providing some level of assurance.
2. AAL2: Two-factor authentication offering high confidence.
3. AAL3: Uses cryptographic protocols for very high confidence.

6.6 Self-Sustainable Model for Authentication Ecosystem

NIDP aims to generate revenue by offering authentication services to government and private sector organizations. Revenue streams include transaction fees for Yes/No and e-KYC authentication services and licensing fees for ASPs. Pricing models consider value, affordability, sustainability, and international best practices. Discounts or exemptions may apply for government services, social protection programs, and partners conducting registrations.

7. Fayda - Communication

Our comprehensive communication strategy, **Fayda for Ethiopia**, is designed to effectively engage stakeholders of the Digital ID ecosystem. This strategic plan outlines our approaches to establish clear and impactful communication channels (Mass media, digital media, specific targeted community conversations, and stakeholder consultations) with all relevant parties involved including a holistic identification of target persona's for residents that are situated across diverse socio-demographics for customized communications.

The primary objective is to create a robust framework for conveying the numerous benefits of the Fayda ID program to our stakeholders. By fostering understanding, building trust, and promoting transparency, our strategy aims to encourage widespread acceptance and active participation in this initiative, ultimately contributing to its successful implementation. Fayda for Ethiopia will serve as a guiding roadmap for the various implementing agencies responsible for executing different facets of the communication strategy. This ensures that the Fayda ID program is widely embraced and adopted throughout the nation.

Our communication strategy³ leverages the main use-case strategy and is designed to be resident-centric. We focus on clearly outlining the benefits of the Fayda ID program to establish trust and encourage its utilization and adoption. By emphasizing the direct advantages, addressing concerns, and tailoring our messaging to the needs of residents, we aim to empower individuals and communities, enabling them to access essential services, exercise their rights, and participate fully in the digital economy.

³ Fayda ID [Communication Strategy](#)

Key Communication Objectives include:

1. Awareness: Educate the public and stakeholders about Fayda's importance, benefits, and procedures.
2. Trust: Build and maintain trust in Fayda through transparency and prompt addressing of concerns.
3. Engagement: Foster active participation and collaboration among stakeholders, including government entities, private sector partners, civil society organizations, and the general public, ensuring inclusion.
4. Feedback: Establish channels for continuous feedback to improve the program and address concerns.

Further to the above the strategy also incorporates a National Grievance Redressal Mechanism informing the public about feedback mechanisms and disseminating information on how to report grievances through various channels.

8. Fayda - Compliance & Accountability

8.1 Personal Data Protection and Privacy

The National ID Program (NIDP) adheres to strict data protection laws⁴ and international standards to ensure the privacy and security of personal data. The Ethiopian Digital Identification Proclamation No. 1284/2023 provides the legal framework for Fayda, emphasizing the protection of personal identifiable information (PII). NIDP collects only minimal data required for identification, avoiding sensitive information like occupation, religion, or ethnicity. Data is collected solely for identification purposes.

8.2 Legal Mandates and Principles

NIDP operates under clear legal mandates to establish a reliable digital ID system. The Ethiopian Digital Identification Proclamation institutionalizes the NIDP, outlining its responsibilities and ensuring legal safeguards for data protection. Key principles guiding Fayda include inclusiveness, data minimization, interoperability, transparency, and accountability. NIDP ensures that personal data is used only with the individual's consent and for specified purposes, maintaining strict confidentiality.

8.3 Compliance Monitoring

NIDP has established internal protocols and guidelines to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory requirements. Regular audits and monitoring activities are conducted to assess adherence to data protection standards and identify any potential risks. The program includes mechanisms for continuous improvement, ensuring that compliance measures evolve with changing legal and technological landscapes.

⁴ Personal Data Protection [Draft Proclamation](#).

9. Fayda – Governance, Supervision & Performance

Governance Structure

Fayda's governance structure is designed to ensure strong oversight, accountability, and effective implementation. A Program Steering Committee (PSC) oversees the nationwide rollout of Fayda, comprising top leadership from governmental institutions. The PSC provides strategic direction, monitors progress, and addresses any high-level issues that arise during implementation.

Measurement, Monitoring, and Supervision

NIDP employs robust monitoring and evaluation mechanisms to track the performance of the Fayda program. Key performance indicators (KPIs) are defined to measure progress towards enrollment targets, system usage, and overall impact. Regular reports and evaluations are conducted to assess the effectiveness of the program, and its communication strategy, identify challenges, and implement necessary adjustments.

Stakeholder Engagement and Collaboration

Effective governance requires strong collaboration with stakeholders, including government entities, private sector partners, and civil society organizations. NIDP engages stakeholders through regular consultations, workshops, and meetings to align objectives, address concerns, and foster a cooperative environment. This collaborative approach enhances the program's reach and impact, ensuring that all relevant parties are involved in the successful implementation of Fayda.

Institutionalization and Sustainability

The Proclamation designates the NIDP as the entity responsible for implementing Fayda until a permanent institution is established. The vision is to create a public enterprise that will manage Fayda once critical milestones and KPIs are achieved. This approach ensures continuity and sustainability, allowing Fayda to evolve and adapt to future needs.

Transparency and Reporting

Transparency is a core principle of Fayda's governance. NIDP ensures that non-sensitive program information, including progress reports, audit results, and statistical data, is publicly available. This openness promotes accountability and builds public trust in the Fayda program. Regular updates and communication with stakeholders keep everyone informed about the program's status and developments.

Overall, Fayda's compliance and governance frameworks are designed to ensure the secure, transparent, and efficient implementation of the digital ID system. By adhering to strict data protection standards and fostering strong governance practices, NIDP supports Ethiopia's digital transformation and promotes an inclusive and trustworthy identity ecosystem.